

SEA4001W: Exercise 4 - Calculate the Taylor series expansion

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Exercise 4
 → general formula (3rd order)

1) $f(x) \approx f(x_0) + f'(x_0)(x-x_0) + \frac{f''(x_0)(x-x_0)^2}{2!} + \frac{f'''(x_0)(x-x_0)^3}{3!} + O((x-x_0)^4)$

slide 51

$f(x) = \frac{x}{x+1}$

$\therefore f'(x) = \frac{(x+1)(1) - x(1)}{(x+1)^2} = \frac{1}{(x+1)^2}$ * quotient rule

$\therefore f''(x) = \frac{-2}{(x+1)^3}$ → differentiate $f'(x)$ using the chain rule $= -2(x+1)^{-3} \cdot 1 = \frac{-2}{(x+1)^3}$

$x = x_0$

$\therefore f(x_0) = \frac{x_0}{x_0+1}$ & $f'(x_0) = \frac{1}{(x_0+1)^2}$ & $f''(x_0) = \frac{-2}{(x_0+1)^3}$

$= f(x) = \frac{x_0}{x_0+1} + \frac{1}{(x_0+1)^2}(x-x_0) - \frac{1}{(x_0+1)^3}(x-x_0)^2 + O((x-x_0)^3)$

$\frac{f''(x_0)}{2!} = \frac{\frac{-2}{(x_0+1)^3}}{2} = \frac{-1}{(x_0+1)^3}$

↳ halve the f'' term

2) $f(x) = \frac{2x^2}{x^2}$

$= \frac{2}{x^2} = 2x^{-2}$ → so that we don't have to use the quotient rule, can now use power rule

$f'(x) = 2 \cdot (-2) \cdot x^{-3} \rightarrow \frac{d}{dx} [ax^n] = nax^{n-1} = -2 \cdot 2x^{-2-1} = -4x^{-3} = \frac{-4}{x^3}$

$f''(x) = -4 \cdot (-3) \cdot x^{-4} \rightarrow \frac{d}{dx} [ax^n] = nax^{n-1} = -3 \cdot -4x^{-3-1} = 12x^{-4} = \frac{12}{x^4}$

2 cont.) $x = x_0$

$$\therefore f(x_0) = \frac{2}{x_0} \quad \& \quad f'(x_0) = \frac{-4}{x_0^3} \quad \& \quad f''(x_0) = \frac{12}{x_0^4}$$

$$f(x) = \frac{2}{x_0^2} - \frac{4}{x_0^3} (x - x_0) + \frac{6}{x_0^4} (x - x_0)^2 + \mathcal{O}((x - x_0)^3)$$

$$\frac{f''(x_0)}{2!} = \frac{\frac{12}{x_0^4}}{2} = \frac{6}{x_0^4}$$

3) $f(x) = \ln x^2 \rightarrow \ln(x^n) = n \ln(x)$ (log power rule)
 $= 2 \ln(x)$

$$f'(x) = 2 \cdot \frac{1}{x} = \frac{2}{x} = 2x^{-1} \rightarrow \frac{d}{dx} [\ln x] = \frac{1}{x}$$

$$f''(x) = \frac{d}{dx} [2x^{-1}] = -2x^{-2} = \frac{-2}{x^2}$$

$$\rightarrow \text{power rule } (-1) \cdot 2 \cdot x^{-2} = -2x^{-2}$$

$$x = x_0$$

$$f(x_0) = 2 \ln(x_0) \quad \& \quad f'(x_0) = \frac{2}{x_0} \quad \& \quad f''(x_0) = \frac{-2}{x_0^2}$$

$$\therefore f(x) = 2 \ln(x_0) + \frac{2}{x_0} (x - x_0) - \frac{1}{x_0^2} (x - x_0)^2 + \mathcal{O}((x - x_0)^3)$$

$$\frac{f''(x_0)}{2!} = \frac{\frac{-2}{x_0^2}}{2} = \frac{-1}{x_0^2}$$